

PharmaConnect

SWOT Analysis · Patient ↔ Pharmacist Medicine Discovery Platform · Lagos, Nigeria

S

STRENGTHS
Live · Data · AI

W

WEAKNESSES
No payments · Manual

O

OPPORTUNITIES
120k+ pharmacies

T

THREATS
Incumbents · Trust

S Strengths

PRODUCT

- **Deployed today** at pharmaton.web.app — live, working product
- Dual-sided network: patients find medicine, pharmacists get discovery
- AI search maps symptoms/categories to real drug names; “Did you mean” fallback
- Broaden-search shows all Lagos pharmacies when local stock is empty

DATA & TRUST

- Real pharmacy locations from OpenStreetMap + WHO EML drug catalog
- NAFDAC verified badge; PCN license required for pharmacist signup

TECHNOLOGY

- React 19 + Vite 8; Firebase Auth (email + Google); Express 5 + SQLite on Railway
- Pharmacist sidebar dashboard; fully responsive down to iPhone 8
- Search limits via localStorage; unlimited whitelist for team/demo accounts

W Weaknesses

PRODUCT GAPS

- No payment integration — Paystack not wired; zero revenue flowing today
- Delivery/logistics decided by team but not yet built — gap in patient journey
- No push notifications; demand insight “This Week” card uses static mock data

DATA & TRUST

- Inventory accuracy requires pharmacists to update manually — no auto-sync
- PCN number is self-reported; not validated against the official PCN registry
- Search limits stored in localStorage — bypassable by clearing browser storage

SCALE & BUSINESS

- SQLite will bottleneck above 1,000 concurrent pharmacists
- Anthropic API is single point of failure for all AI features in production
- Firebase sends verification emails to spam; no pharmacist retention after trial

O Opportunities

MARKET

- **120,000+ registered pharmacies** in Nigeria — only a fraction are online
- No dominant patient-facing pharmacy discovery platform exists in Nigeria
- Lagos is 20M people; early adoption creates compounding network effects

PRODUCT EXPANSION

- Delivery/logistics layer closes the commerce loop (already planned by team)
- Paystack enables pharmacist subscriptions + patient delivery payments
- Abuja, Port Harcourt, Kano expansion via same OSM + seed data approach
- WhatsApp bot integration — meets patients where they already are

PARTNERSHIPS & REVENUE

- NAFDAC/PCN partnerships create regulatory moat; SDG 3 opens grant funding
- Pharma distributors (Emzor, Fidson) would pay for demand forecasting data

T Threats

COMPETITION

- HealthPlus and MedPlus have brand trust, physical stores, and are building apps
- mPharma (Ghana) already operates in Nigeria with deeper pockets
- Remedial Health (B2B supply chain) could pivot patient-facing at any time

ADOPTION BARRIERS

- Pharmacist behaviour change: daily digital inventory vs. 20 years of pen-and-paper
- English-only UI excludes Yoruba/Igbo/Hausa speakers — significant market gap

REGULATORY & OPERATIONAL

- NAFDAC/PCN licensing requirements for digital health platforms — compliance risk
- Nigeria Data Protection Regulation (NDPR) compliance needed for health data
- **Accuracy is existential** — wrong stock data destroys patient trust immediately
- AI API cost scales with usage; small team with Paystack + delivery still outstanding